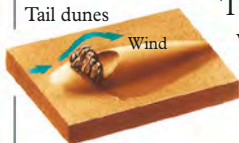




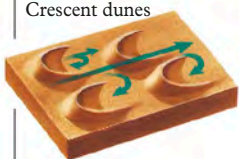
DESERTS

Did you know that deserts come in many different forms? They can be a sea of rolling sand, a huge area of flat and stony ground, or mountainous areas of shattered rock. There are hot deserts and cold deserts. So what do these very different areas have in common?

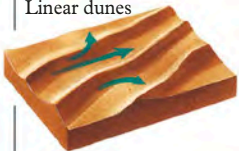
Tail dunes



Crescent dunes



Linear dunes



Star dunes



Wind power

Wind blows the sand into hills which are called dunes. These have different shapes and names.

The answer is that they are all very dry and they all get less than 10 inches (25 cm) of rain each year. This rain may not fall regularly. Instead, it may all come in a single day and cause a dramatic flash flood.

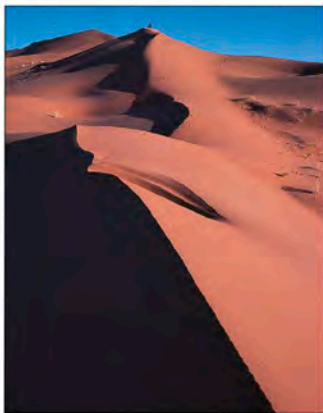
Natural rock arch

A butte is a small, flat-topped hill.

A large, steep-sided area with a flat top is called a mesa.

Dunes

Hard rock that has been worn into a pinnacle is called a chimney or pipe rock.



Sea of sand

A desert may be hard to live in, but it can be stunning to look at. These dunes are in Saudi Arabia.

A cuesta is a step of hard rock.

